

Sports Nutrition Basics

Fueling for Performance and Recovery

Sports nutrition focuses on providing the right nutrients at the right time to support athletic performance and recovery. Carbohydrates, protein, and fluids play central roles. The specific needs vary by sport, intensity, and individual goals.

Macronutrients for Athletes

Carbohydrates are the primary fuel for high-intensity exercise. Protein supports muscle repair and growth. Fats are a useful fuel for longer, lower-intensity activity. Balancing these macronutrients supports training and performance.

Pre, During, and Post Exercise

Before exercise, a meal with carbohydrates and some protein supports energy. During prolonged exercise, fluids and easily digested carbohydrates maintain performance. After exercise, protein and carbohydrate support recovery.

Suggested Items:

- Before: oats with banana and a glass of milk
- Before: whole wheat toast with peanut butter
- During (long sessions): banana, dates, or oral rehydration drink
- After: curd with fruit and nuts
- After: dal with rice and vegetables
- After: scrambled eggs with toast and a glass of milk

Reference Table

Timing	Goal	Example
Before	Fuel up	Oats + banana + milk
During	Maintain	Banana, dates, electrolytes
After	Recover	Curd + fruit + nuts
After	Recover	Dal + rice + vegetables
After	Recover	Eggs + toast + milk

Conclusion

Hydration is critical. Drinking water before, during, and after exercise supports performance. For sessions longer than an hour, an electrolyte drink may be useful.